

Deputy Report for Incident 21-C1490

Page 3 of 8

Narrative

STATE OF IDAHO)
SS
County of Caribou)

_____ Detective Heath Downs _____, upon oath duly deposes and says:

That your affiant, a Deputy Sheriff with the Caribou County Sheriff's Office makes the following statement:

That on the __8th__ day of __November__ 2021, I initiated an investigation on the Defendant, _____ Christopher Slate Blackburn _____, for the crime of Sexual Abuse of a child under the age of sixteen years of age.

NARRATIVE

Synopsis:

Received a report from Idaho Health and Welfare concerning a sex abuse case which occurred in the Grace area. Both suspect and victim reside in Utah. Utah authorities investigating and have conducted forensic interview on victim. Report and video recording of the interview to be sent to our office for review.

Incident:

On 11/08/2021 Idaho Health and Welfare sent a report to this office which detailed a sex abuse case which occurred in the Grace area. The report states that a juvenile female identified as _____ had been sexually abused by her adult brother in law. Suspect was identified as a Slate Blackburn.

The report states that the juvenile lives in _____ and was visiting Grace ID with family. This was reported to be during the months of August or September of 2021. The family was staying at a cabin when Blackburn stated that it was too hot inside the cabin and would be going out to a tent. Blackburn had the child come to the tent with him. The juvenile stated that Blackburn gives her massages frequently. On the night in question, the juvenile stated that she had fallen asleep in the tent and was awakened by something touching her. She stated that Blackburn was touching her buttocks. She also stated that he started to touch her under her bikini, on her breasts and vagina. She states that he then flipped her over so that her legs were across him. She states that he then pulled his pants down and placed her hand on his penis, forcing her to fondle him as he moved back and forth.

The juvenile stated that she pretended to be asleep the whole time. She states that he asked her on numerous occasions if she was awake but she continued to feign sleeping. She states that she was trying to think of a way to get out of the situation and finally did so by telling Blackburn she needed to use the bathroom and then leaving.

The suspect (Blackburn) is a law enforcement officer with American Fork Police Dept. There have also been allegations that came to light after this incident with two of the juvenile female's sisters which occurred in Utah as

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well.

The victim was interviewed by the Children's Justice Center in Richfield, Utah. This was what was disclosed in that interview. There is video and audio recording of same that is to be sent to our office for review. When the report and recording are received, report to continue.

INTERVIEW WITH [REDACTED]

I received a package from the Sevier County Sheriff's office in Richfield UT. The package contained CD disks of interviews conducted concerning this case. I reviewed the recording marked "Evidence CD 1" which is a recorded interview with the juvenile female who is the victim in this case. The following will be a detailed overview of the interview. If more detail is needed refer to the recording itself. As the victim is a minor, she will hereafter be known as "juvenile female".

The interview begins with the interviewer introducing himself as "Rusty". Upon review of the other interviews I learned that this individual is Rusty Edwards who works for Sevier County Sheriff's office.

Rusty explains to her the ground rules in the interview such as always telling the truth, not to guess at answers and be as detailed as she can be. The interview begins with her describing hobbies that she has such as dancing and skiing. She describes a ski trip to Steamboat Colorado. She described getting to the hotel where they were staying and going skiing the next day after breakfast. She described the lockers where they kept ski equipment as well as the ski lift being able to hold six people at a time. She stated that she did not fall for the first two days they were there. She also described her sister getting a broken foot during a dance competition while they were there as well. She stated that she had a hard time skiing in the powder snow as she had'nt done that before. She also described skiing between the trees as well. It should be noted that this interview is similar to forensic interviews conducted by Bright Tomorrows. These questions are designed to allow the victim to recount an experience and being as detailed as possible. After talking about some other experiences that she had that made her happy and sad as well as her day up until the interview, she was asked if she knew why she was there.

She stated that she knew why she was there and stated that her brother in law, who she identified as "Slate Blackburn" had "sexually assaulted her. Rusty asked her to tell him what happened.

She said she was in Idaho for a family vacation and Slate was sleeping outside in the tent. He asked if anyone wanted to go to the tent with him. She said that she volunteered and that she trusted him as she has known him since she was three years old. She said that he likes to give massages and was massaging her neck and back. She described going to sleep and being awakened by Slate touching her. She said that he was "grabbing my butt". She then said that he took her hand and put it on an innapropriate spot on him. She said that she moved her hand away and pretended to be asleep. She said that he touched her on her "top body" under her bathing suit as well as her lower body under the suit as well.

She was hesitant to use medical terminology in her description of where she was touched. Rusty told her that it was ok for her to use the words "penis, vagina and breasts". She stated that Slate took his pants off and placed her hand on his penis. She described him wrapping her hand around his penis and began thrusting his hips back and forth.

She stated that all this was scaring her and that when the actions stopped for a minute, she pretended to wake up and said she needed to go to the bathroom. She left the tent and went inside. She said that Slate went inside as well and told her that he was just getting a drink. She told him that she was going to stay inside and used that excuse that she didn't want to be cold in the morning.

Rusty asked some clarifying questions. He first asked her about the tent. She said that the tent was set up outside with an air mattress inside. She said that she had taken a blanket outside with her. She said that she was wearing a flannel shirt and shorts on as well as her bathing suit as undergarments as they had been swimming earlier.

She said that she was laying in a position in which one of her legs was over Slate's waist. She again said that he had always been in her life and he had always given massages. She did not feel the massage was out of the ordinary, however she felt the other touching was not and that she felt uncomfortable and not safe.

Rusty asked her to describe the touching. She said that he touched her breasts under her swim top and also grabbed her in her vaginal area. She said that she did not like this and felt that she needed to get out.

She said that she felt a need to tell someone and told a friend. She said that her friend had encouraged her to tell her mother but she was hesitant. She also said that she should ask her sister if anything had happened to her. She said that one day she asked her sister if she ever felt uncomfortable around Slate. Her sister said that she did feel uncomfortable around him. She asked her to describe it and she said that she felt uncomfortable sexually. Her sister went on to tell her of a time that Slate had made her hold his penis as well. She told her that she was going to tell their mother about what had happened in the tent and her sister asked her to not tell about her experience.

Rusty again asked her to describe the touching. She clarified by saying that he touched her underneath her bikini on both her breast(s) and vagina. She then said that afterward is when he made her touch his penis with out his pants on. She stated "I knew it was that because his pants aren't hairy". She described feeling hair (likely pubic hair) as well as "skin" contact. She said she did not see anything because she was pretending to be asleep. She also stated that he would ask her if she was awake throughout this incident. She said that when the touching stopped was when she pretended to wake up and say she needed to go to the bathroom.

Rusty asked her when all this happened. She said that it was around the end of August or first of September of 2021. She stated they had gone to Grace Idaho to her grandfather's residence. It should be noted that her grandfather is Thayne Keele who resides at 1695 Black Canyon Ln in Grace ID. this is the probable location of the incident.

Rusty asked if anything like this had happened to her before. She said that it had not. She then related a story of an incident which happened at her older sister's baby shower. This sister is married to Blackburn. She stated that while she and her other sisters were at the shower, they play a game that can be likened to "tag", except that in order to "tag" each other they slap each other on the buttocks. She used the word "butt tag" to describe the game as

well. She stated that they have played this game their whole lives and did not think of it as inappropriate. She said that they asked Slate to play with them and he said that he couldn't as that would be "sexual assault". She said that she felt that this was a strange statement in that he had done these things to her but could not play this game with them.

They then took a break. When Rusty came back to the room he told her he had just a couple of questions. He asked if anything like this had happened to anyone else that she knew of. She stated she didn't know. He asked if anything else like this had happened to her and she stated that she had talked with authorities about another incident. This incident did not occur in this jurisdiction however so no investigation will be done by this department. As of this time, the case will be forwarded to the prosecutor for pending charges.

Conclusion:

It is alleged that Christopher Slate Blackburn did touch the breasts and vagina of [REDACTED] who is thirteen years of age whereas Blackburn is twenty five years of age. Blackburn did this in order to gratify his lust, passion and/or sexual desires. This occurred in the town of Grace Idaho on or about the end of the month of August or first part of the month of September of the year 2021. It is recommended that Blackburn be charged with violation of I.C. 18-1506: Sexual abuse of a child under the age of sixteen. I have been informed that Blackburn is facing charges in the state of Utah as well and as such will most likely face those charges first. This report will be sent to the prosecutor for the State of Idaho to file as well.

I certify (or declare) under penalty of perjury to the law of the State of Idaho that the foregoing is true and correct.

4-4-2023

Date

Smith S. Davis

Signature